PROJECT 18

AI Customer Persona Builder with Synthetic Survey

AI Tools Curriculum – Project Report

Project objective	Use synthetic survey data and AI-assisted analysis to build customer personas for a healthy-snack business.
Dataset	25 fictional college-student responses
Tools	ChatGPT (analysis support) and Microsoft Excel / Google Sheets (data organisation)
Data note	All respondents and responses in this report are fictional and created for demonstration.

Prepared as a student project demonstration. Replace the student details below if your faculty requires them.

Student Name: _____ Class / Department: _____

Date: _____

1. Introduction

Businesses use customer personas to understand the needs, preferences, motivations and difficulties of likely customers. This project demonstrates a simple AI-assisted workflow: create a synthetic survey, organise responses in a spreadsheet, identify patterns, and convert those patterns into practical customer personas.

2. Objectives

• Create a structured dataset containing 25 fictional student responses.

• Identify popular snack types, budget ranges, purchase frequency and important buying factors.

• Find recurring complaints that a business could address.

• Create two fictional personas grounded in the sample data.

• Suggest practical marketing and product improvements.

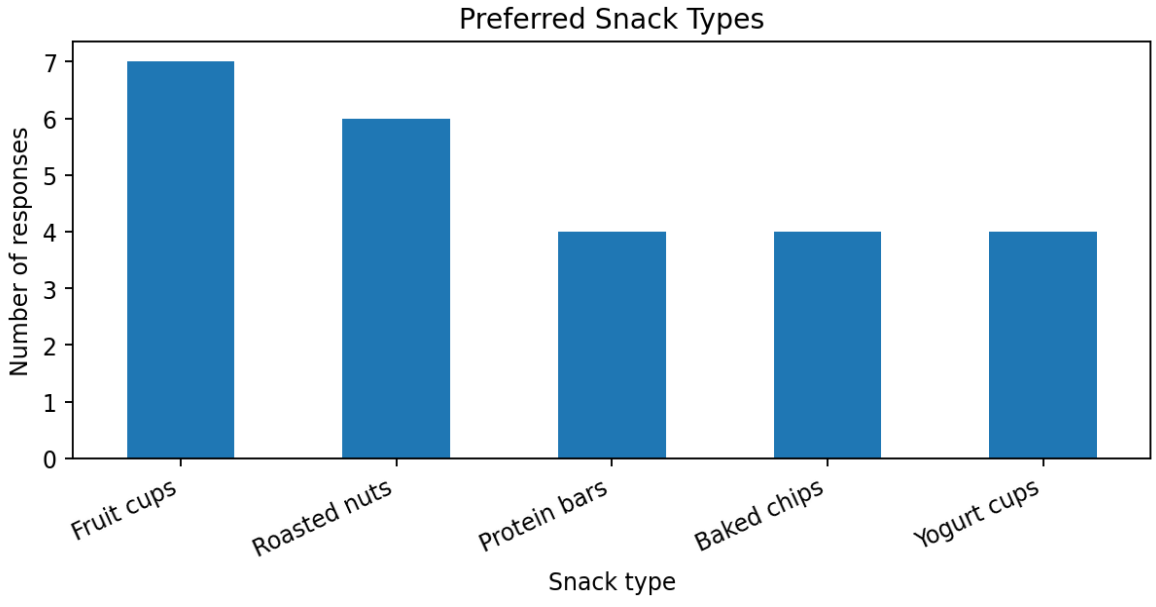
3. Methodology

A fictional sample of 25 college students aged 18–22 was created. Each row includes a preferred snack, budget per snack, purchase frequency, most important buying factor and one main complaint. The dataset was summarised using frequency counts. ChatGPT can assist with interpreting the summaries and drafting personas; Excel or Google Sheets can be used to store, filter and chart the data. No real students were surveyed.

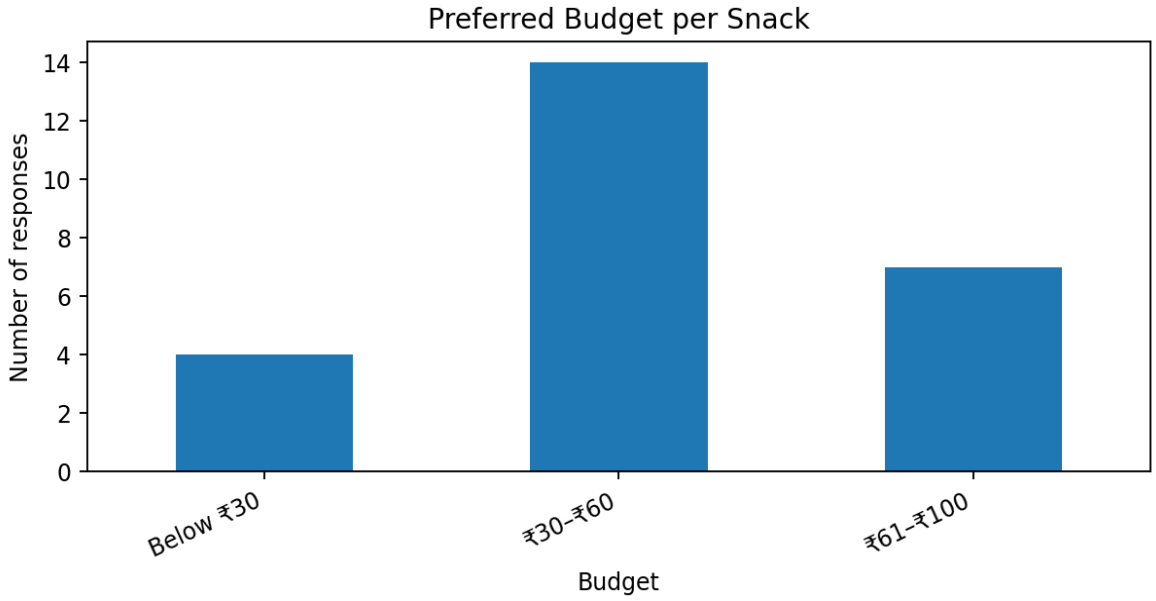
4. Dataset and Findings

The dataset contains 25 fictional responses. The average age is 19.8 years, with an age range of 18–22. 17 of 25 respondents say they buy snacks daily or 2–3 times per week.

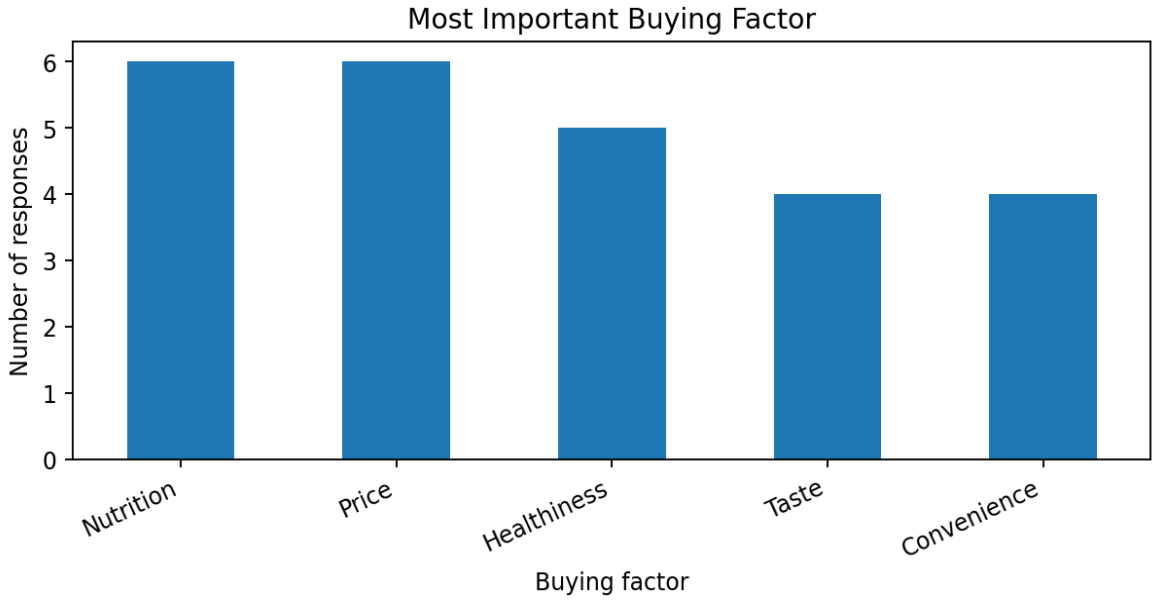
Preferred snack types

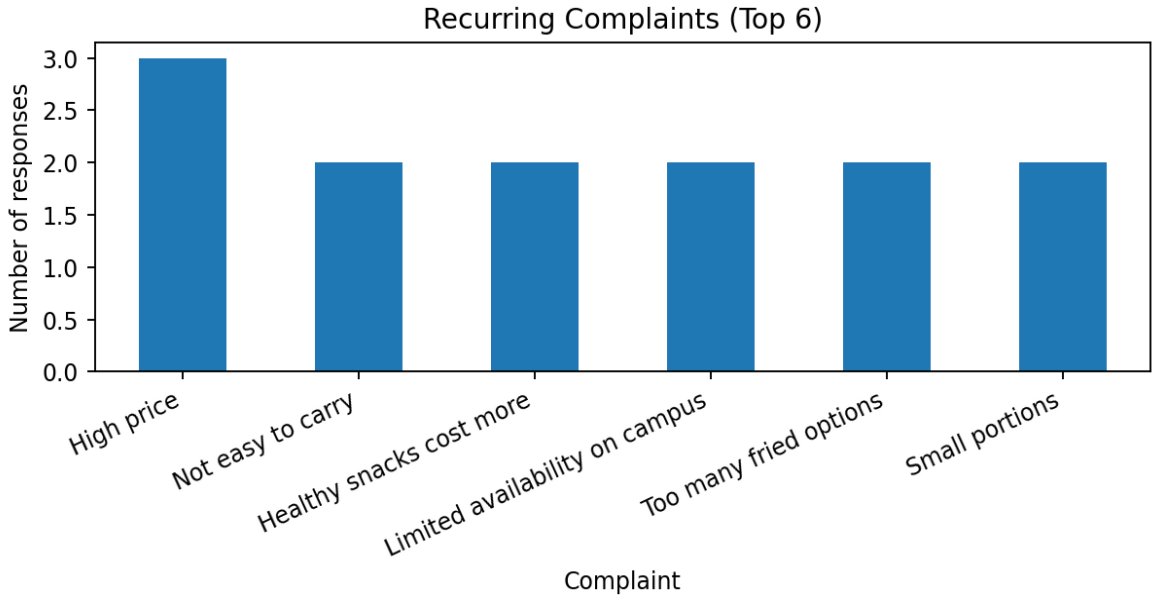


Budget per snack


Preferred Budget per Snack
Number of responses
0
2
4
6
8
10
12
14
Below ₹30
₹30–₹60
₹61–₹100
Budget

5. Buying Factors and Complaints





Interpretation

• Fruit cups are the most selected snack (7 responses), followed by roasted nuts (6).

• The most common budget is ■30–■60 (14 responses), suggesting that an affordable price point is worth testing.

• Nutrition, healthiness, taste and price appear repeatedly as important decision factors. The sample indicates that students balance value with taste and perceived health benefits.

• Recurring complaints include high prices for healthy snacks, limited availability on campus, limited flavours and concerns about portion size or packaging.

6. Customer Personas

Persona 1	Budget-Conscious Student
Profile	Age 18–20; buys snacks between classes; prefers familiar, convenient options.

Likely needs	Affordable portions, clear prices, easy access near classrooms and a few flavour choices.
Motivation	Get a tasty snack without spending too much.
Pain points	Healthy snacks can feel expensive; some options are difficult to find on campus.
Suggested message	“A tasty, convenient snack that fits your student budget.”

Persona 2	Health-Focused Student
Profile	Age 19–22; pays attention to nutrition and often chooses fruit cups, nuts or protein bars.
Likely needs	Clear ingredient and nutrition information, reliable availability and variety.
Motivation	Choose a filling snack that supports an active study day.
Pain points	High prices, limited flavours and uncertain availability.
Suggested message	“Simple snack choices for busy college days.”

7. Recommendations

1. Offer student-friendly price points. Test snack options priced around ■30–■60 and provide smaller portions so students can try products at a lower cost.

2. Improve campus access and variety. Place products near common student areas or partner with campus stalls. Rotate a small number of flavours and track which sell best.

3. Make benefits easy to understand. Display clear ingredient, allergen and nutrition information. Use truthful claims and avoid describing a product as healthy unless the ingredients support that claim.

8. Sample AI Prompt

“Analyse this synthetic survey of 25 fictional college students about healthy snacks. Summarise snack preferences, budget, purchase frequency, buying factors and complaints. Create two evidence-based fictional customer personas and three practical marketing recommendations. Do not claim these are real-world findings.”

9. Limitations

• The responses are synthetic and do not represent actual students.

• A sample of 25 fictional responses is too small to make reliable claims about all college students.

• The personas are hypotheses for planning, not verified descriptions of real customers.

• A real business should conduct an actual survey and compare these patterns with sales data before making major decisions.

10. Conclusion

This project demonstrates how a spreadsheet and an AI assistant can be used together to turn structured survey responses into readable insights and customer personas. In this fictional sample, affordability, taste, nutrition and campus availability are useful areas to investigate. The recommendations provide a starting point for product and marketing experiments, but should be validated with real customer feedback.

Appendix: Dataset

The accompanying Excel workbook contains all 25 fictional responses, summary tables and the sample AI prompt. It can be opened in Microsoft Excel or imported into Google Sheets.